

# Envelope 08 • Rajab • Four Years and No Charge

**Style A — Lantern Night.** Fraunces and Literata. Every word read from source; every drawing from tools/envelope\_art.py, which has no figure in it.

Still open where it shows: the fact panel is TO VERIFY and the return address is not set.

ENVELOPE — C5, 229 × 162 MM

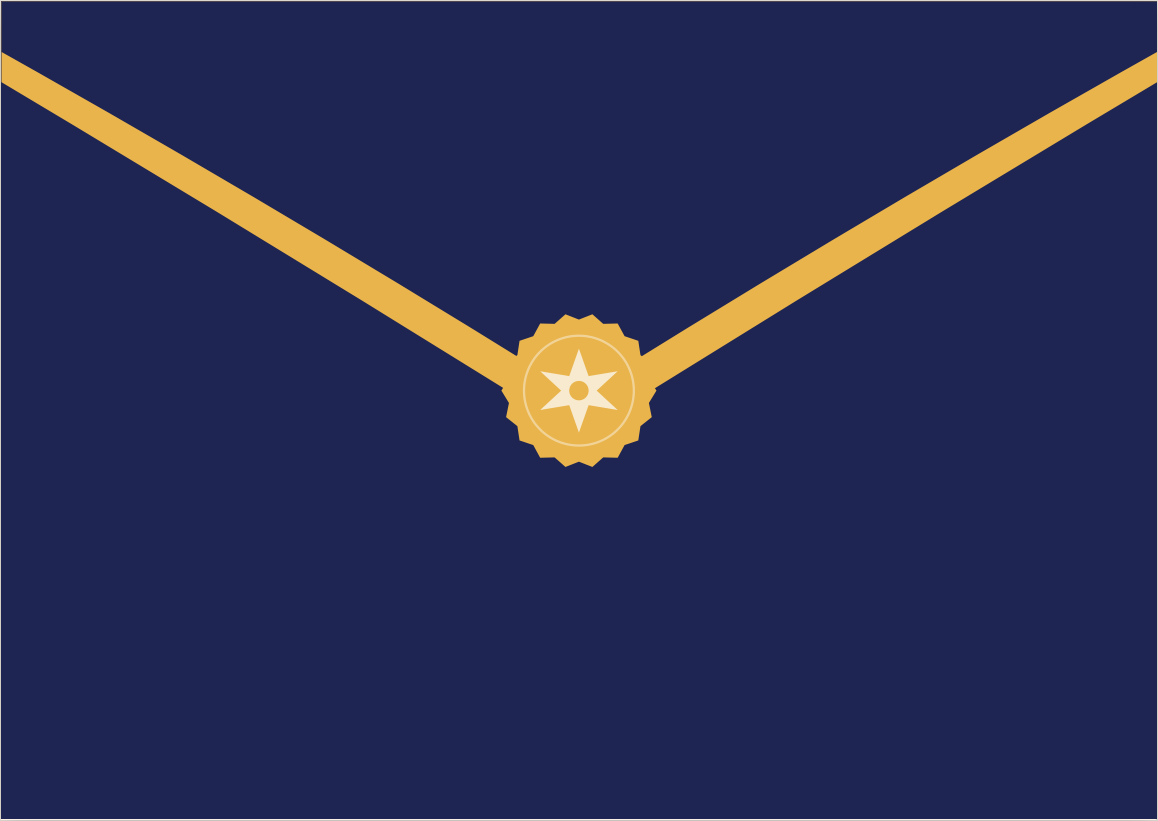
NOOR POST

One of fourteen. Open it on the day.



FOR

[Child's name]



Back, with the seal

INSIDE THE FLAP

ENVELOPE 08 · RAJAB ·  
INSIDE THE FLAP

## Open together.

🕒 About twenty-five  
minutes

● is the grown-up. ○ is you.

- 1 The letter — read it out loud, ● and ○ taking turns
- 2 The hadith card
- 3 The prints
- 4 Open the case file
- 5 The stickers
- 6 The postcard

THE LETTER — ONE A4 SHEET FOLDED TO A5

## Imam Musa al-Kadhim

(peace be upon him)

B. 128 AH, NEAR MEDINA · D. 183 AH, BAGHDAD

- **Where and when.** Medina for most of it, then Basra and Baghdad — not as a traveller. He was brought to both.
- **Who was ruling.** The Abbasid caliphs, from Baghdad. Four of them held power in his lifetime, ending with Harun al-Rashid, whose court is the one that turns up in storybooks as a place of poets and lamps.
- **The imamate.** About thirty-five years, from 148 AH, from the age of about twenty. **The longest of the fourteen**, and the last four of it were spent in a cell.
- **What he left.** Answers, in enormous number — his period is one of the best-recorded, because so much of it came out in writing from confinement. And the beginnings of the network of representatives that his descendants would depend on entirely.
- **Hamida.** His mother. She was not from Arabia. She taught — women came to her with questions, and the accounts have his father sending people to learn from her by name.
- **Elsewhere in the world.** In the same years, in Europe, Charlemagne was about a year away from being crowned emperor in Rome, and had begun collecting scholars to teach reading in a kingdom where almost nobody could.

He died in a prison in Baghdad in 183 AH, after four years held without charge. Shia accounts hold that he was killed on the orders of Harun al-Rashid.

## Four Years and No Charge



• is the grown-up · ◉ is you · ◉◉ is together

- Here is a thing that sounds impossible and is not. A man was held in prison, moved from city to city, for about four years, and in all that time nobody ever said out loud what he had done.

### ◉ Nobody told him?

- Nobody told anybody. There was no trial. There was no accusation written down. There was no day in a courtroom where somebody stood up and said this is *what he did*. He was simply taken, and kept, and years went past.

### ◉ Then why not let him go?

- That is the question, and I am not going to answer it. Hold on to it.
- He was moved between prisons and between jailers. Different cities, different men in charge. That happened more than once, and it is one of the strangest details in the whole account.
- At one point somebody was sent in to watch him and report back — to write down what he said, what he did, who he complained about. And what came back was that he prayed, and that he did not complain about anyone.

### ◉ Not once?

#### FOUR YEARS AND NO CHARGE · CONTINUED

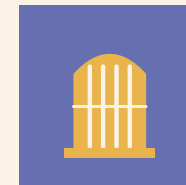
- That is what was reported. Whatever else you doubt, doubt it knowing the report came from someone whose job was to find something.
- People started calling him al-Kadhimi. It is worth knowing exactly what that word is. It is not a title anyone gives you for being important. It describes a specific thing a person does — swallowing anger, holding it in the chest, not letting it out onto the person in front of you.
  - **So it's a nickname?**
    - It is a description of a behaviour, and he got it from people watching him under the worst pressure a person can be under. Names like that are earned in public.
  - **Could you do four years without complaining? Say yes or no, honestly.**
    - Now go back to the question I left with you. A caliph with an army, a treasury and every judge in the empire holds one man for four years — and never charges him with anything. Not once.
  - He could have. It would have been easy. So why not?

2

#### SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

•◦

**Why hold a man and  
never put him on trial?**



Then the hadith card.

3





IMAM AL-KADHIM SAID



**“Good neighborhood is not  
abstinence from harm. It is to  
tolerate the harm (of the  
neighbors).”**



Imam al-Kadhim

NOOR POST · THE FOURTEEN

The chain

Every card in this box is one link. Lay all fourteen in order and the chain runs from the Prophet to the last of the twelve, each one passing on what was given.



Fourteen segments · historical order

IN OUR WORDS

**A good neighbour does not just avoid causing trouble. A good neighbour puts up with the trouble the neighbours cause.**

Noor Post's own words, not the translation.

Tuhaf al-Uqul, short maxims, no. 13. Translated by Badr Shahin, Ansariyan Publications, Qum.



THE CASE FILE

THE CASE FILE

## The question

### Why hold a man for four years and never put him on trial?

Five evidence cards. Read them in any order. Then say your answer out loud, before anyone opens the sealed card.



## EVIDENCE

# 1

There was no charge. No accusation was written down and no trial is recorded. He was held, and that was all.



**EVIDENCE**

**2**

He was moved between prisons and jailers more than once. Different cities, different men put in charge of him.



**EVIDENCE**

**3**

Someone was sent to watch him and report. The report said he prayed and did not complain about anyone.



## EVIDENCE

### 4

Outside the prison, nothing stopped.  
People still sent him questions. Money  
still moved. Answers still came out.



**EVIDENCE**

**5**

He was the great-great-grandson of the man killed at Karbala, and everyone in Baghdad knew what had happened to that man and what it had cost the rulers who did it.



**Sealed**

Parent: open this only when the child has committed to an  
answer. Not before.

## THE ANSWER

**A trial would have required a charge, and a charge would have required proof, and there wasn't any.**

Work it forwards. Put him in a courtroom and he gets to speak, in public, with the whole city listening — and he is better at speaking than anyone they could put opposite him. Then the judge has to rule. If the judge acquits him, the caliph has just proved he was innocent all along. If the judge convicts him on nothing, everyone can see it.

**Either verdict is worse for the caliph than no verdict at all.**

So there is no trial. He stays held, indefinitely, and nobody is ever forced to say why. It looks like carelessness. It is the opposite — it is the only move that keeps every option open and costs nothing publicly.

Evidence 2 is the tell. **You do not keep changing a prisoner's jailers unless the jailers keep becoming a problem** — and the accounts say what the problem was. Men set to guard him kept coming away impressed. That is not something you can put in a report, and it is not something you can allow to continue.

And Evidence 5 is why they never went further, for years. They had watched what happened last time.

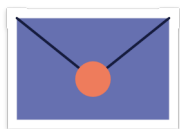
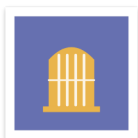






Event print — ring position 8. Red dashed circle = punch, screen only

STICKER SHEET — A6, KISS-CUT



RETURN POSTCARD — A6 LANDSCAPE



**We opened this one  
together.**

- \_\_\_\_\_
- \_\_\_\_\_

Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.



**Noor Post**

[ Return address — not set ]

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